Chrysler Valiant Dodge Phoenix (Australia) Specification & Service Reference - Page 1/1

AUSTRALIAN AUTOMOTIVE ARCHIVE - TECHNICAL & SPECIFICATION DOSSIER

Make: Chrysler Valiant | Model: Dodge Phoenix | Australian Market Years: 1960-1973
Vehicle Type: 4-door Sedan / 4-door Hardtop (pillarless) | Segment: Luxury Full-size American Flagship |
Assembly Plants (AU): Mile End, Adelaide, South Australia (1960-1964), Tonsley Park, Adelaide, South Aust

1. MODEL OVERVIEW & AUSTRALIAN MARKET NOTES

The Dodge Phoenix was Chrysler Australia's grand American luxury flagship from 1960 to 1973. Co nceived to compete head-on with the Ford Galaxie and Chevrolet Impala/Bel Air in the prestige g overnment, executive, and pastoralist market, the Phoenix was assembled in Adelaide from North American CKD packs, using Dodge Dart/Polara, Plymouth Fury, and Chrysler bodies married to besp oke factory right-hand drive Plymouth dashboards. Spanning the early finned PD/RD series throug h to the majestic 'fuselage'-bodied models of 1969-1973, every Phoenix was powered by burly Ame rican Chrysler V8 engines?predominantly the 318ci (5.2L) 'Poly' and 'LA' small-block V8s, and t he optional 383ci (6.3L) 'B-block' Big Block V8 in the opulent Phoenix 400 Hardtop. Sumptuously appointed with Torqueflite 3-speed automatic transmissions, power steering, push-button radios , and deep plush interiors, the Phoenix was the undisputed car of choice for Australian politic ians, judges, and graziers.

Because full right-hand drive manufacturing of American full-size cars ceased in North America, Chrysler Australia created bespoke tooling at Tonsley Park to assemble the Phoenix with right- hand drive steering boxes, Australian-made glass, batteries, tyres, and interior trim. The pill arless 400 Hardtop introduced in 1967 represented the absolute summit of Chrysler Australia lux ury before the model was retired in 1973.

SERIES / GENERATION: PD-PF (PD / PF Dodge Phoenix) [1960-1964]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan | ANCAP: None
Early finned tail and slab-side Plymouth Fury-derived body, assembled at Mile End, Adelaide. Po wered by the 318ci 'Poly' V8 with push-button Torqueflite automatic.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- Poly-318-V8: 5.2L (5211cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 168.0 kW / 420.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Phoenix Sedan: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed push-button Torqueflite automatic, AUD $4400-$4850, Fuel

Factory Configurations:

* Phoenix Sedan | Sedan | Poly-318-V8 | 3-speed push-button Torqueflite automatic | RWD | 168.0kW/420.0

SERIES / GENERATION: DB-RD (DB / RD Dodge Phoenix & 400 Hardtop) [1965-1973]

Body Styles: 4-door sedan, 4-door pillarless hardtop | ANCAP: None
Long-wheelbase full-size luxury cruiser and iconic 'fuselage' body styling from 1969. Assembled at Tonsley Park with 318ci LA V8 and 383ci Big Block in Phoenix 400 Hardtop.

Engines Offered in Australia:

- LA-318-V8-Phoenix: 5.2L (5211cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 172.0 kW / 461.0 Nm
- BigBlock-383-V8: 6.3L (6277cc) V8 (Naturally Aspirated, Petrol) | 201.0 kW / 529.0 Nm

Australian Badges / Trims:

- Phoenix 400 Hardtop: Drivetrain=RWD, Trans=3-speed column Torqueflite automatic, AUD $5990-$7250, Fue

Factory Configurations:

* Phoenix 400 Hardtop | Hardtop | BigBlock-383-V8 | 3-speed column Torqueflite automatic | RWD | 201.0k